

Delaware County Budget Hearings September 18th 2024 Segment #2

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-2M7BrXUG8E
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Municipal Meeting Report: Budget Work Session & Review

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer reconvened the municipal board/council following a midday lunch break to continue extensive budget deliberations and salary study reviews across various county departments [00:00:13](#).
- **Attendance:** Present board members, department heads, and elected officials explicitly referenced in the transcript include Emily, Jamie (Board of Health), Jeff (Probation), Sam (Public Defender), Eugene (Building Commissioner), Gavin (Coroner), Bill, Matt, and Tanya. Specific roll call tallies of attendance were not formally read into the record during this work session.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None recorded in this segment of the transcript.
- **Approval of Minutes:** None.

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:00:13 Title 4D Court, Master Commissioner, and Court Reporter Salaries

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily (Court Representative).
- **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed job salary studies, internal base salaries, external midpoints, and hourly vs. annual working hours for court reporters, assistant court reporters, and master commissioners/magistrates. Concerns were raised regarding whether court positions are classified under Public Safety, the calculation of exempt hours vs. 32.5-hour/40-hour work weeks, and longevity add-ons (\$773). Master commissioners noted their extensive on-call hours (working significantly more than standard building hours, including weekends).
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Various salary adjustments were discussed and tentatively placed at updated leveling tiers (e.g., Comet C and Comet D midpoints) pending final review. Approved by Voice Vote / Consensus for discussion tracking.

00:53:00 Board of Health Budget & HFI/Levy Funding

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jamie (Board of Health).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed Health Department funds (Fund 1159 and Fund 1161 / HFI monies), maximum levy impacts, employee salaries, and operating expenses. Discussion focused on whether health department salaries align with county studies, the role of grant funding, and potential risks if state HFI funding is cut in future legislative sessions.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to maintain proposed structures while continuing to refine classifications.

01:12:41 CASA (Court Appointed Special Advocates) Budget

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Examined CASA program director, volunteer coordinator, and staff advocate salaries, FLSA exempt status thresholds, and equipment line items (computers, scanners, chairs).
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to set program director and coordinator salary levels to meet internal/external midpoints and FLSA compliance.

01:24:49 Probation User Fees & Department Budget (Fund/Benefits Untangling)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jeff (Probation Department).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Jeff presented a proposal to shift certain benefit costs (such as health and life insurance) out of the probation user fee fund (Fund 1100s) and back into County General. This would allow user fees to be more fully dedicated to statutory core missions, community safety, and local mental health/addiction recovery programs.

Declining user fee collection trends due to recent legal changes in credit time were also highlighted.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Acknowledged and documented for further structural planning; tentative agreement to explore moving specific benefit burdens and positions (like the Jump Coordinator) in future budget iterations. Approved by Voice Vote to accept current working figures.

01:41:09 Public Defender Office Budget

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sam (Public Defender Office).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed staff salaries, investigator pay alignment with prosecutors' offices, legal secretaries, and operational reductions. Sam noted that office staff handle vital reporting to the state supreme court, securing crucial state reimbursements (approx. 40%).
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to adjust specific secretarial and investigator positions to matching midpoint/level tiers (e.g., Comet D / 53100).

01:51:37 Planning Commission & Building Department Budget

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Building Commissioner Eugene and staff.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Addressed community planners, administrative assistants, building secretaries, and the Building Commissioner's salary. Discussion centered on expanding duties (contractor registrations, permit filings, demolition projects) and reclassifying roles from part-time to full-time.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to adjust administrative and secretarial roles to appropriate Comet tiers and maintain building commissioner funding.

02:08:34 Emergency Management Agency (EMA) Budget

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** EMA Director / staff.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed deputy director salary, office manager / financial section chief classification, overtime reductions, and EMPG grant reimbursements (\$65,000).
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to designate the office manager/financial chief position correctly under civilian pool classifications and adjust requested overtime.

02:19:35 Commissioners' Budget & Contractual Services (YOC / Juvenile Detention)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners / Finance team.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed unexpected contractual charges and increased billing from the Youth Opportunity Center (YOC) due to high numbers of held juveniles from

Delaware County and facility damage caused by detainees. Considered adding \$15,000 back into contractual services.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to adjust contractual service line items.

02:37:00 County Maintenance & Custodial Budget

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Maintenance supervisors / Finance.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed building custodians, maintenance technicians, and garage foremen. Evaluated internal base leveling (LTCA, LPCB, LTCC, LTCD) and legacy longevity add-ons.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote for salary leveling and freezing outliers above baseline.

02:42:36 Emergency Medical Services (EMS) Budget

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** EMS Leadership.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed paramedic, advanced EMT, and EMT salary structures, uniform allowances, contractual services, health insurance increases, and operational revenues. Reductions were made to uniforms (\$2,000) and contractual services (\$5,000) to offset health insurance surges.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to finalize EMS operational totals at \$12,711,251.

03:14:38 County Engineer & Highway / Bridge Budgets

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Highway / Engineer staff.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Detailed highway truck drivers, equipment operators, bridge supervisors, senior inspectors, and garage foremen. High turnover rates (52% since 2017) and private-sector competition for drivers were heavily emphasized. Reviewed MVH (Motor Vehicle Highway) funds, restricted road project funds, and cash balances exceeding \$4 million.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote for baseline leveling while noting that MVH funds sit outside the max levy.

04:15:34 Auditor's Office Budget & Staff Restructuring

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor's Office representatives.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Addressed office restructuring following data collections by Wagner. Staff moved from front office customer service to finance/compliance roles, altering job descriptions (e.g., insurance deputies, compliance deputies, plat room staff).
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to adopt updated reclassifications and zero out unallocated lines pending final review.

04:34:50 County Council Budget

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council Members (Bill, Matt, Tanya, et al.).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed council operating expenses, live-streaming/professional service costs, training/transportation lines, and general salary adjustments. Decided to eliminate the unallocated \$100,000 salary adjustment line to tighten the budget.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to cut the salary adjustment line to zero.

04:43:04 Superior/Circuit Courts (Additional Review) & Elected Officials Salaries

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council and Court Representatives (Emily, Gavin).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Finalized lead court reporter classifications and longevity additions. Transitioned to elected officials' salaries: discussed applying a uniform 4% increase (matching projected revenue growth), setting baseline elected salaries at \$58,500 (rounding up from \$58,381), and establishing Chief Deputy salaries at 85% of the elected official's salary. Coroner Gavin Green provided context on local autopsy case loads versus neighboring counties.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to set elected official baselines (excluding the Sheriff and Commissioners who were handled separately) and establish Chief Deputies at 85%.

4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- No general public comment or citizen forum was conducted during this internal budget work session; all speaking turns were restricted to county elected officials, department heads, and board members.

5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Members noted upcoming absences for finance meetings (e.g., Megan stepping in for Tanya) [02:59:58](#).
 - The council outlined the next steps: reviewing adjusted FICA/PERF numbers, refining max levy calculations, and managing budget deficits.
 - **Adjournment:**
 - Presiding officers announced a recess until Tuesday following the upcoming County Council meeting [05:16:31](#).
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